

Li Runze

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Embodied Intelligence and Generalist Robotic Agents
- Multimodal Foundation Models for Decision-Making
- Vision-Language-Action Models for Robot Control

EDUCATION BACKGROUND

School of Management and Engineering, Nanjing University 9/2021-7/2025

Major: Computer and Financial Engineering | **GPA:** 4.43/5.0 (**Ranking:** 10/40)

Department of Electrical Engineering and Computer Sciences, UC Berkeley(Exchange) 8/2024-12/2024

Major: Computer Science | **GPA:** 4.0/4.0

Relevant Coursework: Machine Learning, Algorithm Design & Analysis, Data Structures, Stochastic Processes, Digital Image and Video Processing

Honors: People's First Prize Scholarship (2/40) | People's Second Prize Scholarship

PUBLICATION

- Zheyuan Zhang*, **Runze Li***, Tasnim Kabir, Jordan Lee Boyd-Graber. NAVIG: Natural Language-guided Analytics with Vision-Language Models for Image Geo-localization, *arXiv preprint arXiv:2502.14638*, 2025
- Hongyin Zhang, Shuo Zhang, Junxi Jin, **Runze Li**, Qixin Zeng, Zifeng Zhuang, Donglin Wang: RobustVLA: Robustness-Aware Reinforcement Post-Training for Vision-Language-Action Models, *arXiv preprint arXiv:2511.01331*, 2025 (under NeurIPS review)
- **Runze Li**, Hongyin Zhang, Junxi Jin, Qixin Zeng, Zifeng Zhuang, Yiqi Tang, Shangke Lyu, Donglin Wang: World-Value-Action Model: Implicit Planning for Vision-Language-Action Systems, *arXiv preprint arXiv:2604.14732*, 2026 (under NeurIPS review)
- Qixin Zeng, **Runze Li**, Shuo Zhang, Hongyin Zhang, Renjie Wang, Libang Zhao, Han Zhao, Haoang Li, Donglin Wang, Chao Huang: CRL-VLA: Continual Vision-Language-Action Learning, *arXiv preprint arXiv:2602.03445*, 2026 (under NeurIPS review)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCES

RA(Full Time), Westlake University(MiLab) 7/2025-Now

Supervisor: Professor Donglin Wang

- Conduct full-time research on embodied intelligence and robot foundation models, with a focus on Vision-Language-Action models, World Models, and robotic manipulation. Research how to bring the “ChatGPT moment” to robot control by developing general-purpose robotic agents capable of instruction understanding, implicit planning, and action generation.
 - Led the first-author project **World-Value-Action** Model, proposing a value-guided implicit planning paradigm for Vision-Language-Action systems and contributing to the full research pipeline from idea formulation to experiments.
 - Contributed to **RobustVLA**, which investigates robustness-aware reinforcement post-training for Vision-Language-Action models to improve robot policy stability and generalization.
 - Contributed to **CRL-VLA**, which studies continual learning for Vision-Language-Action systems and addresses skill acquisition and retention in evolving robotic task settings.

RA(Remote), University of Maryland 7/2024-1/2025

Supervisor: Professor Jordan Boyd-Graber

- Conducted research on natural-language-guided image geolocation using vision-language models and structured geographic clues.
 - Built an automated Python/OpenCV pipeline to extract Google Street View images and geolocation metadata from YouTube videos, collecting 3,000+ data points and expert performance metrics.
 - Co-maintained the Awesome-Geolocation list, summarizing key research trends and insights in image geolocation, which provided a strong foundation for the project’s literature review.
 - Reproduced and benchmarked state-of-the-art geolocation models across multiple datasets, establishing evaluation baselines and conducting ablation studies.
 - Proposed and developed the NAVIG framework, contributing to clue extraction, tool invocation design, experiments, and manuscript writing.

RA, Nanjing University (DisLab) 10/2023-7/2024

Advisor: Professor Li Wenzhong

- Conduct research to advance video super-resolution techniques for enhancing video quality and resolution.
- Designed and implemented advanced algorithms leveraging deep learning and computer vision methodologies to address challenges in video super-resolution.

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- Explored and experimented with cutting-edge techniques, including convolutional neural networks (CNNs), recurrent neural networks (RNNs), and generative adversarial networks (GANs), to improve the resolution of low-quality videos.
- Optimized model architectures and hyperparameters to achieve superior performance in video super-resolution tasks.

ACADEMIC EXPERIENCES

Individual Project, Smart Assistant App Development and Deployment

5/2024-10/2024

- **Backend Development:** Independently built a high-efficiency backend server for optimal stability and performance.
- **Payment and Subscription Management:** Integrated Google Play billing, managing payment flows and subscription logic; developed a user balance system for purchases, renewals, cancellations, and upgrades; utilized Google Billing Pub/Sub for real-time updates; established daily/weekly refresh mechanisms; migrated payment processing to Supabase for enhanced efficiency.
- **Security and Authentication:** Implemented JWT for secure authentication with Bearer tokens and auto-refresh to minimize disruptions.
- **Server Deployment and Logging:** Deployed AWS EC2 instances, configured domains, and set up SSL for secure access; created a logging system with hourly rotation for effective monitoring; used FastAPI to optimize client interactions and ensure efficient OpenAI API connectivity.
- **Published on Google Play:** Successfully launched the app on the Google Play Store.

Member, 19th Citi Financial Innovation Application Competition

1/2024-3/2024

- Joined a team to optimize the equity structure diagram of listed companies using artificial intelligence to enhance information accuracy and precision. My contributions included:
 - Implemented Graph Convolutional Networks (GCN) to classify different companies into risk categories based on their equity structure diagrams.
 - Leveraged the graph-based nature of GCN to capture complex relationships and dependencies within the equity structure diagrams for accurate risk classification.
 - Selected the Hierarchical Graph Pooling with the Structure Learning model as the foundational model for our task.
 - Conducted structural modifications to the model to better adapt it to the specific requirements of financial domain tasks, ensuring its effectiveness in optimizing equity structures.
- Ranked Top 20 nationwide.

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Member, Cloud-Based Voluntary Teaching Program

7/2022-9/2023

- Utilized various online teaching tools and platforms to provide math and computer science tutorials for rural students and employed online education technology to integrate educational resources and enable real-time communication, enhancing remote learning experiences.